Operate it

Short portal paths and the command that does the same job. Full click paths are in each lab; check a command's syntax with Get-Help before you rely on it.

SC-500 Academy posters
Front: where things live, and how to build them
Checked against Microsoft Learn on 20 October 2026

Nine portals, and what SC-500 does in each

Portal	Address	SC-500 work there
Azure portal	portal.azure.com	Resources, Policy, RBAC, Key Vault, networking, Defender for Cloud
Microsoft Entra admin center	entra.microsoft.com	Conditional Access, authentication methods, PIM, apps and consent, Agent ID
Microsoft Defender portal	security.microsoft.com	Sentinel, incidents and blast radius, Security for AI, Audit search
Microsoft Purview portal	purview.microsoft.com	DSPM (was DSPM for AI), Audit, labels, DLP for Copilot
Microsoft 365 admin center	admin.microsoft.com	Agents: inventory, block, owners
SharePoint admin center	<tenant>-admin.sharepoint.com	Data access governance reports, RCD, RAC
Power Platform admin center	admin.powerplatform.microsoft.com	Threat detection for Copilot Studio, per environment
Microsoft Foundry portal	ai.azure.com	Guardrails, blocklists, AI gateway for the Foundry resource
Security Copilot	securitycopilot.microsoft.com	Workspaces, roles, plugins, agents, usage

Sentinel in the Azure portal retires on 31 March 2027. Learn its Defender portal paths.

Which PowerShell talks to what

Module	Covers	Connect with
Az	Everything in Azure Resource Manager, including Sentinel (Az.SecurityInsights)	`Connect-AzAccount`
Microsoft.Graph	Entra ID: users, apps, consent, Conditional Access, PIM	`Connect-MgGraph -Scopes ...`
ExchangeOnlineManagement	Audit configuration and audit search	`Connect-ExchangeOnline`
Microsoft.Online.SharePoint.PowerShell	Sites, RCD, RAC, data access governance	`Connect-SPOService`
Azure CLI	AKS and ACR settings, where the CLI is the documented route	`az login`

The AzureAD and MSOnline modules are retired. Commands below that start with Mg are Microsoft Graph PowerShell.

Identity

1.1.1 · 1.1.2 · 1.1.5 · 1.1.6

Task and portal path	PowerShell or CLI
Conditional Access policy Entra ID > Conditional Access	`New-MgIdentityConditionalAccessPolicy`
Authentication method Entra ID > Authentication methods > Policies	`Update-MgPolicyAuthenticationMethodPolicy AuthenticationMethodConfiguration`
PIM eligibility (Entra role) ID Governance > Privileged Identity Management	`New-MgRoleManagementDirectoryRoleEligibilityScheduleRequest`
PIM eligibility (Azure role) PIM > Azure resources	`New-AzRoleEligibilityScheduleRequest`
User consent settings Entra ID > Enterprise apps > Consent and permissions	`Update-MgPolicyAuthorizationPolicy`
Admin consent workflow Same blade, Admin consent settings	`Update-MgPolicyAdminConsentRequestPolicy`
User-assigned managed identity Managed Identities > Create	`New-AzUserAssignedIdentity`

Governance

1.3.1 · 1.3.4 · 1.3.5 · 4.1.3

Task and portal path	PowerShell or CLI
Assign a policy Policy > Assignments	`New-AzPolicyAssignment`
Fix existing resources Policy > Remediation	`Start-AzPolicyRemediation`
Exempt a resource Policy > Exemptions	`New-AzPolicyExemption`
Re-evaluate now No portal button: command, CLI or REST	`Start-AzPolicyComplianceScan`
Lock a resource Resource > Locks	`New-AzResourceLock -LockLevel ReadOnly`
Assign or define a role Access control (IAM)	`New-AzRoleAssignment` `New-AzRoleDefinition`
Turn a Defender plan on Defender for Cloud > Environment settings > Defender plans	`Set-AzSecurityPricing -PricingTier Standard`

No GA PowerShell route: use the portal

- Copilot Studio real-time protection: Defender portal and Power Platform admin center, both sides. Blocking rules: Settings, Security for AI, Policies & rules
- Agent management in the Microsoft 365 admin center (the Graph agent API is beta)
- Foundry guardrails and blocklists (or the REST API)
- Security Copilot roles, plugins and agents

A regulatory standard is a policy initiative, so `New-AzPolicyAssignment` can add one.

Data

1.2.1 · 1.2.4 · 2.1.1 · 2.2.1 · 2.2.2

Task and portal path	PowerShell or CLI
Key vault with purge protection Key vaults > Create	`New-AzKeyVault -EnablePurgeProtection`
Vault firewall Key vault > Networking	`Update-AzKeyVaultNetworkRuleSet -DefaultAction Deny`
Secret, key Key vault > Objects	`Set-AzKeyVaultSecret` `Add-AzKeyVaultKey`
Disable Shared Key, anonymous access Storage account > Configuration	`Set-AzStorageAccount -AllowSharedKeyAccess $false -AllowBlobPublicAccess $false`
Storage firewall Storage account > Networking	`Update-AzStorageAccountNetworkRuleSet -DefaultAction Deny`
Stored access policy Container > Access policy	`New-AzStorageContainerStoredAccessPolicy`
SQL: Entra admin, then Entra-only SQL server > Microsoft Entra ID	`Set-AzSqlServerActiveDirectoryAdministrator` `Enable-AzSqlServerActiveDirectoryOnlyAuthentication`
SQL auditing SQL server > Auditing	`Set-AzSqlServerAudit`

Network

2.3.1 · 2.3.2 · 2.3.6 · 2.3.8 · 2.3.9

Task and portal path	PowerShell or CLI

NSG rule, ASG
NSG > Inbound security rules
	`Add-AzNetworkSecurityRuleConfig`
	`Set-AzNetworkSecurityGroup`
	`New-AzApplicationSecurityGroup`

Security admin rule, then deploy Network manager > Configurations, Deployments	`New-AzNetworkManagerSecurityAdminRule` `Deploy-AzNetworkManagerCommit`
Private endpoint and DNS Resource > Networking > Private endpoint connections	`New-AzPrivateEndpoint` `New-AzPrivateDnsVirtualNetworkLink`
Firewall policy, threat intel deny Firewall Policy > Rule collections, Threat intelligence	`New-AzFirewallPolicy -ThreatIntelMode Deny` `New-AzFirewallPolicyRuleCollectionGroup`

Prove the path
Network Watcher > IP flow verify, Next hop
	`Test-AzNetworkWatcherIPFlow`
	`Get-AzNetworkWatcherNextHop`
	`Get-AzEffectiveNetworkSecurityGroup`

Compute and apps

3.2.1 · 3.2.2 · 3.2.3 · 3.2.8 · 3.3.2 · 3.3.3 · 3.3.7

Task and portal path	PowerShell or CLI
Trusted launch Create VM > Security type	`Set-AzVMSecurityProfile -SecurityType TrustedLaunch` `Set-AzVMUefi -EnableSecureBoot $true -EnableVtpm $true`
Encryption at host VM > Disks (VM deallocated)	`Update-AzVM -EncryptionAtHost $true`
Bastion VM > Connect > Bastion	`New-AzBastion`
Just-in-time access Defender for Cloud > Workload protections > Just-in-time VM access	`Set-AzJitNetworkAccessPolicy` `Start-AzJitNetworkAccessPolicy`
AKS: Entra only, admission control AKS > Security configuration, Policies	`az aks update --disable-local-accounts` `az aks enable-addons --addons azure-policy`
ACR: no shared credential Registry > Access keys	`az acr update --admin-enabled false`
App Service restrictions Web app > Networking > Access restriction	`Add-AzWebAppAccessRestrictionRule` `Update-AzWebAppAccessRestrictionConfig -ScmSiteUseMainSiteRestrictionConfig`

Monitoring and Microsoft 365

3.1.1 · 4.2.8 · 4.2.9 · 4.2.10

Task and portal path	PowerShell or CLI
Workspace daily cap Log Analytics workspace > Usage and estimated costs	`Set-AzOperationalInsightsWorkspace -DailyQuotaGb`
Table retention Defender portal > Microsoft Sentinel > Configuration > Tables	`Update-AzOperationalInsightsTable -TotalRetentionInDays`
Automation rule Microsoft Sentinel > Automation	`New-AzSentinelAutomationRule`
Audit on, and search On: Purview > Audit. Search: Purview or Defender portal > Audit	`Set-AdminAuditLogConfig -UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled $true` `Search-UnifiedAuditLog`

RCD and RAC on a site
SharePoint admin center > Active sites (RAC: allow it for the tenant first)
	`Set-SPOSite -RestrictContentOrgWideSearch $true`
	`Set-SPOTenant -EnableRestrictedAccessControl $true`
	`Set-SPOSite -RestrictedAccessControl $true`

Ids such as 2.3.6 are positions in the official skills outline, assigned by the Academy. Microsoft does not number them.

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Operate it

The fastest way to stop each thing, and what that action leaves running. The right-hand column is where incidents get missed.

SC-500 Academy posters
Back: contain and clean up
Checked against Microsoft Learn on 20 October 2026

Identities and access

1.1.5 · 1.3.7 · 3.1.4 · 3.1.11

To stop	Do this	It does not stop
An app's access to your data	`Remove-MgOauth2PermissionGrant` `Remove-MgServicePrincipalAppRoleAssignment` Enterprise apps > app > Permissions	Users consenting again; access through Entra roles, Exchange RBAC or Teams RSC; tokens already issued
An app signing in at all	`Update-MgServicePrincipal -AccountEnabled:$false`	Tokens already issued, until they expire
A leaked app secret	`Remove-MgApplicationPassword`	Tokens already issued with it
An Azure role assignment	`Remove-AzRoleAssignment`	Other assignments (groups, parent scopes); up to 10 min to apply; managed identity tokens cached about 24 h
A PIM eligibility	PIM > Assignments > Remove	An activation already in progress may persist: check Active assignments
An autonomous agent	Conditional Access policy that blocks the agent identity	Tokens issued before the policy, until they expire; its blueprint creating new agent identities
An agent across the tenant	Microsoft 365 admin center > Agents > Block portal only	SharePoint and Foundry agents outside Copilot Chat; the agent identity's Entra permissions
A Security Copilot agent	Security Copilot > the agent > Pause portal only	

Network, compute and apps

3.2.3 · 3.3.2 · 3.3.3 · 3.3.8

To stop	Do this	It does not stop
An open management port	Remove the allow rule, or add a deny from Internet with a lower number; then JIT	Connections already open; Bastion (it connects from inside the network) unless a deny from Any outranks its allow
A running VM	`Stop-AzVM`	Disk charges, and data on its disks
The AKS admin credential path	`az aks update --disable-local-accounts` `az aks rotate-certs`	Entra users with Kubernetes roles. Without rotate-certs, admin kubeconfigs already downloaded keep working
The ACR admin password	`az acr update --admin-enabled false`	Repository-scoped tokens, anonymous pull if on, identities with pull or push roles
A WAF that only logs	WAF policy > Policy settings > Prevention	Attacks no rule matches

Data

1.2.5 · 2.1.1 · 2.1.4 · 2.2.1

To stop	Do this	It does not stop
A SAS with no stored access policy	`New-AzStorageAccountKey -KeyName key1`	SAS signed with the other key; user delegation SAS
A SAS bound to a stored access policy	`Remove-AzStorageContainerStoredAccessPolicy`	SAS signed directly with the account key
Every user delegation SAS	`Revoke-AzStorageAccountUserDelegationKeys`	Key-signed SAS
All key-based access	`Set-AzStorageAccount -AllowSharedKeyAccess $false`	Entra ID access with a data role, and user delegation SAS
Public reach to storage or SQL	`Set-AzStorageAccount -PublicNetworkAccess Disabled` `Set-AzSqlServer -PublicNetworkAccess Disabled`	Private endpoint paths; storage exceptions and resource instance rules already set
A leaked secret	`Update-AzKeyVaultSecret -Enable $false` then rotate it	A copy already read
SQL logins	`Enable-AzSqlServerActiveDirectoryOnlyAuthentication`	Entra users who hold database permissions

Clean up: the six places things are left behind

Bucket	Commonly left behind
Resources	The resource group, and anything created outside it. `Get-AzResource -TagName 'sc500-module'`
Subscription scope	Defender plans still billing; policy assignments; role assignments left orphaned by deleted identities
Directory scope	App registrations, service principals, Conditional Access policies, test users and groups
Soft-deleted remains	Key vault names held for the retention period; Log Analytics workspaces for 14 days
Access	Activated PIM roles: deactivate them
Verify	`Get-AzSecurityPricing` shows nothing on Standard you did not mean; next day's cost shows no new spend

From the Academy's teardown template, 00-03.

Beyond the exam: incident response

Not SC-500 objectives. Useful when the control above failed.

To stop	Do this
A compromised user's sessions	`Revoke-MgUserSignInSession`
The account itself	`Update-MgUser -AccountEnabled:$false`
A compromised device	Defender portal > device > Isolate device

Actions you cannot undo

1.2.2 · 1.3.8 · 4.3.2

- irreversible Turning on Key Vault **purge protection**.
- irreversible **Locking** an immutable Recovery Services vault, and **always-on** soft delete.
- irreversible Removing **Everyone** as Security Copilot contributor: it cannot be added back.
- irreversible **Purging** anything soft-deleted.
- **Lockout risk:** a Conditional Access policy with no break-glass exclusion; removing your standing admin role before proving PIM activation.

Deleted is not gone

1.2.2 · 1.3.8

Thing	Recoverable for
Key vault and its objects	7 to 90 days (soft delete). Purge protection blocks purging until then
Blobs and containers	Soft delete period you set
Log Analytics workspace	14 days. Same name, subscription, group and region brings it back; Sentinel does not come back
Entra users, Microsoft 365 groups, app registrations	30 days
Microsoft 365 agents	30 days
Backup data in a Recovery Services vault	14 days by default; enhanced soft delete longer

Prove it worked

Control	Check
Conditional Access	Sign-in logs > Conditional Access tab
Role assignments	`Get-AzRoleAssignment -Scope`
Policy	`Get-AzPolicyState`
Defender plans	`Get-AzSecurityPricing`
Key vault	`Get-AzKeyVault`
NSG and routing	`Get-AzEffectiveNetworkSecurityGroup`, `Get-AzNetworkWatcherNextHop`
AKS local accounts off	`az aks get-credentials --admin` must fail
Sentinel ingestion	Query the `Usage` table
Audit on	`Get-AdminAuditLogConfig`
RCD on a site	`Get-SPOSite` > RestrictContentOrgWideSearch

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